

SPANISH VERB CONJUGATIONS - PAGAR (TO PAY)

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PRESENT SIMPLE:-- Presente

Yo pago - I pay

Tú pagas - You pay

Él/Ella paga - He/She pays

Nosotros pagamos - We pay

Vosotros pagáis - You all pay (Spain)

Ellos pagan - They pay

PAST SIMPLE (Preterite) ⚠ Spelling Change:-- Pretérito Perfecto

Yo pagué - I paid

Tú pagaste - You paid

Él/Ella pagó - He/She paid

Nosotros pagamos - We paid

Vosotros pagasteis - You all paid (Spain)

Ellos pagaron - They paid

FUTURE SIMPLE:-- Futuro

Yo pagaré - I will pay

Tú pagarás - You will pay

Él/Ella pagará - He/She will pay

Nosotros pagaremos - We will pay

Vosotros pagaréis - You all will pay (Spain)

Ellos pagarán - They will pay

PRESENT CONTINUOUS:-- Presente Continuo / Presente Progresivo

Yo **estoy pagando** - I am paying

Tú **estás pagando** - You are paying

Él/Ella está pagando - He/She is paying

Nosotros estamos pagando - We are paying

Vosotros estáis pagando - You all are paying (Spain)

Ellos están pagando - They are paying

PAST CONTINUOUS:-- Pretérito Imperfecto Continuo

Yo **estaba pagando** - I was paying

Tú **estabas pagando** - You were paying

Él/Ella estaba pagando - He/She was paying

Nosotros estábamos pagando - We were paying

Vosotros estabais pagando - You all were paying (Spain)

Ellos estaban pagando - They were paying

FUTURE CONTINUOUS:-- futuro continuo/progresivo

Yo **estaré pagando** - I will be paying

Tú **estarás pagando** - You will be paying

Él/Ella estará pagando - He/She will be paying

Nosotros estaremos pagando - We will be paying

Vosotros estaréis pagando - You all will be paying (Spain)

Ellos estarán pagando - They will be paying

PRESENT PERFECT:-- *Pretérito Perfecto Compuesto

Yo **he pagado** - I have paid

Tú **has pagado** - You have paid

Él/Ella ha pagado - He/She has paid

Nosotros hemos pagado - We have paid

Vosotros habéis pagado - You all have paid (Spain)

Ellos han pagado - They have paid

PAST PERFECT:-- Pretérito Pluscuamperfecto

Yo **había pagado** - I had paid

Tú **habías pagado** - You had paid

Él/Ella había pagado - He/She had paid

Nosotros habíamos pagado - We had paid

Vosotros habíais pagado - You all had paid (Spain)

Ellos habían pagado - They had paid

FUTURE PERFECT:-- Futuro Perfecto

Yo **habré pagado** - I will have paid

Tú **habrás pagado** - You will have paid

Él/Ella habrá pagado - He/She will have paid

Nosotros habremos pagado - We will have paid

Vosotros habréis pagado - You all will have paid (Spain)

Ellos habrán pagado - They will have paid

CONDITIONAL:

Yo **pagaría** - I would pay

Tú **pagarías** - You would pay

Él/Ella **pagaría** - He/She would pay

Nosotros **pagaríamos** - We would pay

Vosotros **pagaríais** - You all would pay (Spain)

Ellos **pagarían** - They would pay

COULD PAY (**PODER + INFINITIVE**): conditional

Yo **podría pagar** - I could pay

Tú **podrías pagar** - You could pay

Él/Ella **podría pagar** - He/She could pay

Nosotros **podríamos pagar** - We could pay

Vosotros **podríais pagar** - You all could pay (Spain)

Ellos **podrían pagar** - They could pay

SHOULD PAY (**DEBER + INFINITIVE**): conditional

Yo **debería pagar** - I should pay

Tú **deberías pagar** - You should pay

Él/Ella **debería pagar** - He/She should pay

Nosotros **deberíamos pagar** - We should pay

Vosotros **deberíais pagar** - You all should pay (Spain)

Ellos **deberían pagar** - They should pay

EXAMPLE SENTENCES:

- Podría pagar la cuenta con tarjeta de crédito.

(I could pay the bill with a credit card.)

- Debería pagar mis impuestos antes de la fecha límite.

(I should pay my taxes before the deadline.)

- Tengo que pagar el alquiler el primer día del mes. (I have to pay the rent on the first of the month.)

⚠️ ****Important Notes on "Pagar"**:**

◆ ****Spelling Change: g→gu before "e"**:**

Pagar follows the same orthographic rule as *llegar*, *jugar*, and *buscar*: the **g** changes to gu** before the vowel **e** to preserve the hard "g" sound.

| Tense | Form | Reason |

|-----|-----|-----|

| ****Preterite Yo**** | pagué | g→gu before e |

| ****Present Subjunctive**** | pague, pagues, pague, paguemos, paguéis, paguen | g→gu before e |

! ****Note****: All other forms keep the **g** because they're followed by a, o, or u: *pago, pagas, pagamos, pagando, pagado*.

◆ ****Regular in All Other Aspects!**** ✅

- Gerund: *pagando*

- Past Participle: *pagado*

- Future/Conditional: *pagaré, pagaría* (full infinitive stem)

 ****Other Verbs with Same g→gu Pattern**:**

| Verb | Preterite Yo | Present Subjunctive |

|-----|-----|-----|

| *pagar* | pagué | que yo pague |

| *llegar* | llegué | que yo llegue |

| *jugar* | jugué | que yo juegue |

| *apagar* | apagué | que yo apague |

| *entregar* | entregué | que yo entregue |

| *navegar* | navegué | que yo navegue |

 ****Important Usage Notes: "Pagar" + Objects**:**

| Structure | Meaning | Example |

|-----|-----|-----|

| *pagar + thing* | to pay for something | *Pago la cena.* (I pay for dinner.) |

| *pagar **a** + person* | to pay someone | *Le pago **a** María.* (I pay María.) |

| *pagar **por** + thing* | to pay for something (emphasis on transaction) | *Pago **por** el servicio.* |

| *pagar **en** + method* | to pay with/in a method | *Pago **en** efectivo.* |

 ****Key Tip**:** Unlike English, Spanish often omits "for" after *pagar* when the object is a thing:

-  *Pago el libro.* (I pay for the book.)

-  *Pago **por** el libro.* (Also correct, slightly more emphatic)

 ****Common Phrases with "Pagar"**:**

| Phrase | Meaning | Example |

|-----|-----|-----|

| *pagar la cuenta* | to pay the bill | *¿Pagamos la cuenta juntos?* |

| *pagar en efectivo/tarjeta* | to pay in cash/by card | *Prefiero pagar en efectivo.* |

| *pagar las consecuencias* | to face the consequences | *Tendrá que pagar las consecuencias.* |

| *pagar adelantado* | to pay in advance | *Pagué adelantado el hotel.* |

| *pagar a plazos* | to pay in installments | *Puedo pagarlo a plazos.* |

| *¡Te la pago!* | I'll get you back! (idiomatic) | *¡Me rompiste el lápiz, te la pago!* |

 ****Pro Tip**:**

In customer service contexts, these phrases are essential:

- *¿Aceptan tarjeta?* (Do you accept cards?)
- *¿Puedo pagar con móvil?* (Can I pay with my phone?)
- *La cuenta, por favor.* (The bill, please.)
- *¿Me da recibo?* (Can I have a receipt?)

 ****Ready for the next verb!**** Just say: ****Next verb: [verb]**** 